

Class Exercise 14/15: Organizing the Discussion, Limitations, and Future Directions

Instructions: **Draft** ideas for some of the content for your discussion section.

Requirements: To successfully complete this exercise, you are required to:

1. **respond to** the following prompts; the prompts ask you to
 - o recap your results in *plain language*, or language that is free of any statistical language (e.g., main effect) and statistical parameters (e.g., p-values)
 - o identify the specific result(s) you would like to discuss and speculate more within your discussion section
 - o make concrete connections (e.g., comparisons, or explanations for “fit”) between your study findings and previous findings in the literature

Please use a **word processing program** (such as MS Word) to complete this exercise.

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Discussion Prompts

1. Write a brief paragraph of the results in *plain language*. Remember, the first paragraph of your discussion is a reminder to your reader of what your research questions are and what your results revealed. You can also highlight the goals and strengths of your study.

The current study aimed to examine the relationship between intellectual humility and apology quality, and whether a post-transgressional response also impacted apology quality. In accordance with our preliminary analysis, we did find a positive correlation between intellectual humility and apology quality. However, our primary analyses did not support our hypotheses. We found there was no significant effect of intellectual humility on apology quality. Furthermore, apology quality was unaffected by a victim's post-transgressional response. Finally, the interaction between intellectual humility and post-transgressional responses also did not affect apology quality. These findings do not undermine the strength of our study, which utilized an experimental design. This goes beyond the limitations of only using a correlational design.

Brainstorm ways we might interpret or explain the main effects and interactions—what are some plausible explanations for our findings?

Main effect of intellectual humility on apology quality:

- Our study aimed to heighten one's intellectual humility by having them imagine a scenario where they acted in accordance with the definition of

intellectual humility. Perhaps we fell short in actually heightening their intellectual humility, even temporarily.

Main effect of post-transgression response on apology quality:

- After reading through a scenario, participants were either given a forgiving or unforgiving response by the victim. The scenario may not have been severe enough to induce any major effect on the transgressor's apology. Furthermore, the actual response itself may not have been as forgiving or unforgiving as we had hoped the participant would find.

Interaction between intellectual humility and post-transgression response on apology quality:

- Building off of the previous two main effects, we can conclude that the interaction between these two could have suffered for the same reasons we mentioned above.

2. Fill out the following table by completing at minimum two (2) specific connections between your study findings and those within the field. You must use at least one of these articles directly from your Introduction section. Feel free to add additional rows to this table if your group would like to make more than two (2) connections with the existing literature.

Our study found (<i>add effect pattern</i>)...	The previous study found (<i>add citation</i>)...	Combined findings suggest... (e.g., what they together imply about apology behavior, e.g., what the comparison across findings might reveal, reason for inconsistency)
Our study shows there is a statistically significant relationship between intellectual humility and apology quality	Ludwig et al., (2022) also found there to be a statistically significant relationship between intellectual humility and apology comprehensiveness.	Combining these findings, because both experiments found a positive correlation, there is a strengthened likelihood that the two variables are in fact related. This consistency increases our confidence in the relationship between the variables. Additionally, these results confirm our belief that the vignettes used in both studies were temporarily influencing intellectual humility as intended.

Our study found there to be no statistically significant relationship between intellectual humility and post-transgression response	In contrast, Koetke et al., (2024) found there to be a statistically significant relationship between intellectual humility (CIHS) and both positive and negative post-transgression responses from the transgressor's perspective.	Combining these findings, Koetke et al., conducted a more comprehensive statistical analysis, while also controlling for factors such as the social desirability effect. Thus, the difference in results could be explained by the existence of confounding variables influencing our results, while being controlled in Koetke et al.

Limitations, Future Directions

Prompts

In the space below, brainstorm two limitations of your study (other than a small sample size)

1. How does this limitation shape the interpretation of our results?

Self-report:

Participants may have over or under-reacted compared to how they would have actually reacted in the specific scenario we had them imagine themselves in. This helps us understand why we did not find any significant relationships between intellectual humility and post-transgression response on apology quality.

Intellectual humility condition:

When we had participants recall a time when they acted with intellectual humility, this may not have actually heightened their level of intellectual humility as much as we hoped. In turn, they could have completed the survey with their intellectual humility unheightened. This could explain why there were no significant findings for any of our hypotheses.

2. How could a future study be conducted to address these limitations?

A future study conducted in a lab environment with increased internal validity could control for these variables. Creating a simulated environment where participants are not able to self-report but instead have their behaviors constantly monitored could produce more accurate results. Additionally, increasing intellectual humility by putting an individual in a “real” scenario would likely be more effective at influencing this variable than by having an individual just reflect. Lastly, including a pre-manipulation measure would have also given a baseline to ensure the intended effect of the reflection as being achieved.

3. Regardless of limitations, brainstorm two interesting directions for future research. For example, are there other conflict behaviors that IH might be associated with? Other offense or relationship contexts? Besides post-transgression response, are there other variables that might interact with IH in predicting apology behavior?

In future research, an experimental study with increased internal validity would produce interesting results. For example, many of the limitations of this study (social desirability, self-report, ect) could be controlled by having an in-lab experiment where participants were not able to think about their answers, and instead reacted in the moment.

Additionally, looking at how demographic differences between the transgressor and the victim could produce interesting results. For example, does post-transgressional response and/or apology quality change when the victim and transgressor are of different sex, age or race?